

Enemy Balancing Documentation

Overview

This document outlines balance adjustments and design reasoning for core enemy archetypes in the game. The goal of these revisions is to refine combat pacing, improve enemy variety, and ensure each archetype reinforces its intended gameplay role through distinct behavioral and statistical tuning.

Follower (Base Type)

Design Intent:

Followers serve as common grunt enemies encountered frequently alongside Leapers. Individually, they pose a low threat, but in groups, they create sustained combat pressure. Their purpose is to keep players engaged through numbers rather than power.

Identified Issue:

Followers were too weak when encountered in groups, leading to little perceived escalation even in larger engagements.

Adjustment Summary:

To maintain their role as swarm-type enemies, health was increased while slightly lowering damage variance. This creates more consistency in encounters, giving players time to manage multiple targets without being overwhelmed by burst damage.

Changes Implemented:

- Max Health → **65** (was 50)
- Damage Range → **7–11** (was 10–13)
- Stagger Duration → **0.8s** (was 0.5s)
- Base Speed → **3** (was 2)
- Detection Radius → **14** (was 10)

Design Rationale:

The adjustments increase group survivability and maintain the “grunt” identity of the Follower while enhancing their role in crowd control and pacing pressure.

Charger (Base Type)

Design Intent:

Chargers act as aggressive disruptors that push the player into reactive positioning. They're designed to create bursts of intensity through rapid movement and multi-hit combos, testing the player's timing and awareness.

Identified Issue:

Chargers were overtuned, delivering excessive burst damage and stunlock potential with minimal counterplay. Their limited vision wasn't translating effectively into a manageable threat window.

Adjustment Summary:

Tuning focused on reducing damage while amplifying telegraphing and approach distance. This allows players to read and respond to the Charger's aggression more effectively, aligning his combat feel with his visual design and behavior patterns.

Changes Implemented:

- Max Health → **200** (was 160)
- Target Detection Radius → **4** (was 2)
- Base Damage Range → **4–12** (was 10–15)
- Staggered State Duration → **4s** (was 6s)
- Detection Distance → **30** (was 10)
- Stagger Damage Threshold → **40** (was 30)
- Charge Contact Damage → **10** (was 2)
- Charge Duration → **8s** (was 20)

Design Rationale:

These changes create more readable combat dynamics — the Charger becomes a predictable but high-pressure threat. His limited vision reinforces his vulnerability, encouraging smart positioning and spacing from players.

Golem (Base Type)

Design Intent:

The Golem is designed as a slow, high-impact AOE enemy that acts as a “wild card” on the battlefield. His attacks can damage both the player and other enemies, promoting chaos and reactive combat decision-making.

Identified Issue:

The Golem’s threat level was inconsistent. Despite his large size and explosive attacks, his low daze threshold made him too easy to interrupt, reducing tension during encounters.

Adjustment Summary:

The balancing approach focused on amplifying survivability and reinforcing the Golem’s disruptive presence through stronger knockback effects, while avoiding damage inflation that could break pacing balance.

Changes Implemented:

- Ground Smash Launch Force → **10** (was 7.5)
- Dazed Damage Threshold → **30** (was 25)
- Max Health → **250** (was 200)

Design Rationale:

Enhancing the Golem’s durability and crowd-control strength maintains his “unpredictable powerhouse” role. Players must respect his space and use movement strategically, creating dynamic combat flow in group scenarios.

Conclusion

Each enemy type now fulfills a more distinct combat role:

- **Followers** pressure through numbers.
- **Chargers** challenge positioning and reaction time.
- **Golems** disrupt formations and control space.

Together, these updates create a more deliberate rhythm between crowd management, timing, and situational awareness — reinforcing the game’s combat identity through balanced encounter design.